RESOLUTION No. 7186

Resolution Recognizing Indigenous Peoples' Day

RECITALS

A. The Board of Education ("Board"), recognizes that the Indigenous Peoples of the lands that would later become known as the Americas have occupied these lands since time immemorial.

B. What is now known as Portland is situated on the traditional homelands and villages of the Multnomah, Clackamas, Kathlamet, Tualatin, Kalapuya, Cowlitz, and Molalla Nations. In addition to these respected Nations, this land was historically home to more than 60 tribal nations who were forcibly removed, and whose federal recognition was unjustly terminated under the Western Oregon Indian Termination Act of 1954..

C. The Board values the many contributions made to our very own community and the world through Indigenous Peoples' knowledge, labor, technology, science, philosophy, arts, and cultural practices that have substantially shaped the character of Portland and the State of Oregon.

D. The Board has a responsibility and duty to oppose systemic racism toward Indigenous Peoples in the United States, which perpetuates inequities in health, income, housing, employment, and education, and contributes to disproportionate social crises.

E. The Board seeks to confront prejudice and counteract discrimination and institutionalized racism, and to promote awareness, understanding, and positive relations among Indigenous Peoples and all other segments of our District.

F. The Board affirms the State of Oregon's Tribal History/Shared History (SB 13) requirement. It recognizes its importance in ensuring that all students learn the histories, cultures, governments, and sovereignty of Oregon's nine federally recognized Tribes: the Burns Paiute Tribe, the Confederated Tribes of Coos, Lower Umpqua, and Siuslaw Indians, the Coquille Indian Tribe, the Cow Creek Band of Umpqua Tribe of Indians, the Confederated Tribes of Grand Ronde, the Klamath Tribes, the Confederated Tribes of the Umatilla Indian Reservation, the Confederated Tribes of the Warm Springs Reservation, and the Confederated Tribes of Siletz Indians.

G. The Board recognizes the importance of partnering with Tribal governments and Indigenous-led community organizations and actively encourages the development and nurturing of strong, respectful, and lasting relationships. These partnerships are essential to ensuring that Portland Public Schools reflects, respects, and responds to the diverse needs and voices of Indigenous Peoples.

RESOLUTION

1. The Board strongly encourages all Portland Public Schools staff to continue implementing culturally sustaining curricula, including Oregon's Tribal History/Shared History (SB 13), and to meaningfully integrate the rich histories, vibrant cultures, and enduring political sovereignty of Indigenous Peoples throughout the educational experience. We believe that honoring and uplifting these stories is not only essential to a well-rounded education is also a step toward truth, respect, and reconciliation.

2. The Board recognizes the second Monday of October as Indigenous Peoples' Day to honor the enduring strength, resilience, and invaluable contributions of Indigenous Peoples, including the vital presence and leadership of Portland Public Schools' own Indigenous staff, students, and their families.

3. The Board wholeheartedly endorses the well-being, identity affirmation, and academic growth of every Portland Public Schools student, especially American Indian and Alaska Native students, recognizing that nurturing their unique identities and voices through culturally sustaining practices and deep, ongoing partnerships with families and Tribal communities is essential to creating a truly inclusive and empowering educational environment.